

Course evaluation summaries

Included in the current packet are the course evaluation summary reports for recent courses that I have taught that are relevant to this position. The reports cover three courses that I have recently taught at Penn State, and one intensive week-long course that I taught for the ICPSR Summer Program in Summer 2023.

The courses covered in these evaluations include (1) SoDA 501: Big Social Data, Approaches and Issues, (2) PLSC 508: Political Network Analysis, (3) PLSC 597 Special Topics: Machine Learning for Political Research, and (4) Recent Advances in Network Analysis (taught at ICPSR).

Enrollment numbers are acquired before the end of the semester and may differ from the final figure.

Reporting Date: 9/27/2023 7:42 PM **Semester:** 2022/23 SP
Instructor ID: bbd5087 **Instructor:** Bruce Desmarais
Term: 2231 **Session:** 1 **Campus:** UP **College:** LA

Course ID	Course Title	Section	Instruction Mode	Students	Responses	Response Rate
22311--16310	SODA501- Big Social Data	001	P	13	7	53.8%

University Items

A1 Are you taking this course as an elective? Yes: 1 No: 5 I don't know: 0 N: 6 Percent Yes: 16.7%
A2 What grade do you expect to earn in this course? A: 5 / 83.3% B: 1 / 16.7% C or lower: 0 / 0.0%

		Lowest Rating		Average Rating				Highest Rating				
		1	2	3	4	5	6	7	N	Mode	Median	
A3	Rate how well this course increased your understanding of the course topics.	0/ 0%	0/ 0%	0/ 0%	1/14%	0/ 0%	0/ 0%	6/86%	7	7	7	
A4	Rate how well the instructor promoted a meaningful learning experience for you.	0/ 0%	0/ 0%	0/ 0%	0/ 0%	1/14%	1/14%	5/71%	7	7	7	

University Open Ended Items

Open 1 What aspects of this course helped you learn?

Being the first SODA class I enrolled in, I was not sure how this class would go. I can say that this class exceed all my expectations and beyond. Bruce is a fantastic instructor who has a way of presenting the key points of the methods while also introducing us to novel nuances. I especially enjoyed the tutorials that we covered in the class. These were my favorite part of the class and it was more engaging to have class mates present each tutorial. It made the class feel collaborative and helped us to get to know each other more. The articles for each week were an interesting mix of technical to applied papers which I am thankful to have the exposure to. And the guest lectures were also helpful in giving us some variety and different presentation of the topic for the week. Bruce did a fantastic job of creating an educational space that encouraged methodological curiosity, encouraged collaboration between classmates, encouraged technical exploration, made himself available to us, and overall created a learning environment that made it fun. I look forward to the next SODA class and I think he set the bar high in terms of my expectations.

Readings and tutorials were great.

The tutorials were extremely helpful for learning as were the readings!

Open 2 What changes to this course could improve your learning?

Doing group work across departments was really challenging at times, and often I wished we were in duos or working alone

Please don't assign group projects. If you do, let folks pick their own partners. It was a total nightmare. Folks wanted to free-ride with not-so-creative excuses. Although I ended up learning something new, but I also feel it was a total waste of time because we won't be publishing what otherwise is a very interesting project. I practically did everything and at some point, I would like to discuss how I can publish it myself.

It was fantastic, thank you!

Unrestricted Items

B110	Rate the instructor's standards of academic integrity.	0/ 0%	0/ 0%	0/ 0%	0/ 0%	0/ 0%	0/ 0%	6/100%	6	7	7	
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Enrollment numbers are acquired before the end of the semester and may differ from the final figure.

Reporting Date: 9/27/2023 7:43 PM **Semester:** 2022/23 FA
Instructor ID: bbd5087 **Instructor:** Bruce Desmarais
Term: 2228 **Session:** 1 **Campus:** UP **College:** LA

Course ID	Course Title	Section	Instruction Mode	Students	Responses	Response Rate
22281--29840	PLSC508- Political Networks	001	P	12	9	75.0%

University Items

A1 Are you taking this course as an elective? Yes: 3 No: 0 I don't know: 0 N: 3 Percent Yes: 100.0%
A2 What grade do you expect to earn in this course? A: 2 / 66.7% B: 0 / 0.0% C or lower: 1 / 33.3%

		Lowest Rating		Average Rating			Highest Rating		N	Mode	Median
		1	2	3	4	5	6	7			
A3	Rate how well this course increased your understanding of the course topics.	0/ 0%	0/ 0%	0/ 0%	0/ 0%	0/ 0%	1/11%	8/89%	9	7	7
A4	Rate how well the instructor promoted a meaningful learning experience for you.	0/ 0%	0/ 0%	0/ 0%	0/ 0%	0/ 0%	1/11%	8/89%	9	7	7

University Open Ended Items

Open 1 What aspects of this course helped you learn?

Readings were really interesting, and the hands-on demos + assignments were super helpful

The homework assignments helped solidify concepts learned in class. Dr. Desmarais was also always helpful and answered questions- in office hours and via email. It was a really great class.

Bruce structured this class incredibly well, with readings, lectures, and tutorials that thoroughly explained each theory and how it could be applied. He was also very accommodating and considerate of student needs, but still pushed us to genuinely give our best efforts.

The home work and class project assignments were really well paced and helped me to feel like I was really understanding the material. Overall, they were really well structured.

Explaining both the theory and R applications

Basic knowledge of social network analysis and its applications.

The professor was enthusiastic about giving feedback on assignments and answering questions.

Bruce is an amazing learning resource outside the classroom, he is very efficient at conveying information and working through students' questions about course materials. Is an effective tutor. Methods tutorials were a great combination homework and student-led learning resource for coding. Would absolutely keep and encourage for other methods-driven classes.

Open 2 What changes to this course could improve your learning?

Nothing comes to mind.

The one suggestion I would have is going through R programming of network topics together in class. This may be hard to do if students have different levels of comfort with R- but I would have found this helpful.

The application papers were not always the most interesting nor did I always find them useful to read necessarily. Perhaps there could be some other way to get the pedagogical point across (i.e. this paper did this well or something through an exercise).

N/A

Unrestricted Items

B110

Rate the instructor's standards of academic integrity.

0/ 0% 0/ 0% 0/ 0% 0/ 0% 0/ 0% 0/ 0% 9/100% 9 7 7



Enrollment numbers are acquired before the end of the semester and may differ from the final figure.

Reporting Date: 9/27/2023 7:54 PM **Semester:** 2020/21 SP
Instructor ID: bbd5087 **Instructor:** Bruce Desmarais
Term: 2211 **Session:** 1 **Campus:** UP **College:** LA

Course ID	Course Title	Section	Instruction Mode	Students	Responses	Response Rate
22111--25535	PLSC597- Special Topics	002	CR	14	8	57.1%

University Items

A1 Are you taking this course as an elective? Yes: 5 No: 1 I don't know: 1 N: 6 Percent Yes: 83.3%

A2 What grade do you expect to earn in this course? A: 3 / 50.0% B: 3 / 50.0% C or lower: 0 / 0.0%

		Lowest Rating		Average Rating			Highest Rating				
		1	2	3	4	5	6	7	N	Mode	Median
A3	Rate how well this course increased your understanding of the course topics.	0/ 0%	0/ 0%	0/ 0%	0/ 0%	0/ 0%	3/38%	5/63%	8	7	7
A4	Rate how well the instructor promoted a meaningful learning experience for you.	0/ 0%	0/ 0%	0/ 0%	0/ 0%	0/ 0%	3/38%	5/63%	8	7	7

University Open Ended Items

Open 1 What aspects of this course helped you learn?

I really like the textbook by Rhys since it conveys the concepts pretty well while providing codes. And the assigned papers are also providing great examples of empirical research adopting the corresponding technique for each week. And I really enjoy the method tutorials as well.

I like all the method tutorials, it not only offers an opportunity for us to learn and practice implementing models but give us useful resources for future usage.

The class structure was great. An hour or so of lecture about a subject we just read about, then an actual tutorial in how to use what we learned, and then an example of how the method has been applied in research. It's easy to get burned out in 3-hour-long remote classes, but the variety of each class session really helped. Also, having access to a text (Rhys) that provides tutorials in R for each of the methods learned in this class was SUPER helpful. Despite my own difficulties with remote learning, I think I learned more in this class than any other class I've taken related to machine learning.

Student-led methods tutorials and application discussions were a great format to engage with the materials and provide great study content. Lectures were very good overall. Instructor offered substantial mid-semester feedback on course goals and performance, was very helpful.

I learned basics of machine learning. Bruce is very patient and knowledgeable.

The basic machine learning approach

The readings were very informative and useful, and they had great tutorials. The Professor's lectures were useful for clarifying tricky concepts, and he is very knowledgeable and seemingly knew the answer to every question.

Homework assignments were good practice

Open 2 What changes to this course could improve your learning?

More frequent, shorter homeworks. The assignments were good learning experiences, but the amount of new coding introduced meant that a lot of learned material (and subsequent feedback) was combined into single infrequent assignments.

The assignments were really helpful for learning the material (methods tutorial presentation, application presentation, final project presentation, final paper, and three homeworks), but it was a little overwhelming at times. Still, Bruce was always flexible and allowed us to take more time on the assignments when needed because the emphasis was placed on actually understanding the material.

maybe to include more manual approach without relying on standard package, or provide additional resources on that

I think structuring the class would improve discussions as well as making the course more interactive.

I am a bit lost in the neural net approach, I wish it can be elaborated more...

Course Eval - 2023 Recent Advances in Network Analysis

Network Analysis-Desmarais-2023

July 18, 2023 3:43 PM MDT

Q3 - In general, the Workshop was well organized.

#	Field	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Std Deviation	Variance	Count
1	In general, the Workshop was well organized.	1.00	1.00	1.00	0.00	0.00	4

#	Field	Choice Count
1	Strongly agree	100.00% 4
2	Somewhat agree	0.00% 0
3	Neither agree nor disagree	0.00% 0
4	Somewhat disagree	0.00% 0
5	Strongly disagree	0.00% 0
		4

Showing rows 1 - 6 of 6

Q4 - This Workshop advanced my understanding of the subject.

#	Field	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Std Deviation	Variance	Count
1	This Workshop advanced my understanding of the subject.	1.00	1.00	1.00	0.00	0.00	4

#	Field	Choice Count
1	Strongly agree	100.00% 4
2	Somewhat agree	0.00% 0
3	Neither agree nor disagree	0.00% 0
4	Somewhat disagree	0.00% 0
5	Strongly disagree	0.00% 0
		4

Showing rows 1 - 6 of 6

Q5 - My interest in the subject has increased because of this Workshop.

#	Field	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Std Deviation	Variance	Count
1	My interest in the subject has increased because of this Workshop.	1.00	1.00	1.00	0.00	0.00	4

#	Field	Choice Count
1	Strongly agree	100.00% 4
2	Somewhat agree	0.00% 0
3	Neither agree nor disagree	0.00% 0
4	Somewhat disagree	0.00% 0
5	Strongly disagree	0.00% 0
		4

Showing rows 1 - 6 of 6

Q6 - I knew what was expected of me in this Workshop.

#	Field	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Std Deviation	Variance	Count
1	I knew what was expected of me in this Workshop.	1.00	2.00	1.25	0.43	0.19	4

#	Field	Choice Count
1	Strongly agree	75.00% 3
2	Somewhat agree	25.00% 1
3	Neither agree nor disagree	0.00% 0
4	Somewhat disagree	0.00% 0
5	Strongly disagree	0.00% 0
		4

Showing rows 1 - 6 of 6

Q7 - The instructor seemed well prepared for class meetings.

#	Field	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Std Deviation	Variance	Count
1	The instructor seemed well prepared for class meetings.	1.00	1.00	1.00	0.00	0.00	4

#	Field	Choice Count
1	Strongly agree	100.00% 4
2	Somewhat agree	0.00% 0
3	Neither agree nor disagree	0.00% 0
4	Somewhat disagree	0.00% 0
5	Strongly disagree	0.00% 0
		4

Showing rows 1 - 6 of 6

Q8 - The instructor explained material clearly.

#	Field	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Std Deviation	Variance	Count
1	The instructor explained material clearly.	1.00	1.00	1.00	0.00	0.00	4

#	Field	Choice Count
1	Strongly agree	100.00% 4
2	Somewhat agree	0.00% 0
3	Neither agree nor disagree	0.00% 0
4	Somewhat disagree	0.00% 0
5	Strongly disagree	0.00% 0
		4

Showing rows 1 - 6 of 6

Q9 - The instructor encouraged class discussion.

#	Field	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Std Deviation	Variance	Count
1	The instructor encouraged class discussion.	1.00	1.00	1.00	0.00	0.00	4

#	Field	Choice Count
1	Strongly agree	100.00% 4
2	Somewhat agree	0.00% 0
3	Neither agree nor disagree	0.00% 0
4	Somewhat disagree	0.00% 0
5	Strongly disagree	0.00% 0
		4

Showing rows 1 - 6 of 6

Q10 - The instructor was accessible outside of scheduled class meeting times.

#	Field	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Std Deviation	Variance	Count
1	The instructor was accessible outside of scheduled class meeting times.	1.00	3.00	2.00	1.00	1.00	4

#	Field	Choice Count
1	Strongly agree	50.00% 2
2	Somewhat agree	0.00% 0
3	Neither agree nor disagree	50.00% 2
4	Somewhat disagree	0.00% 0
5	Strongly disagree	0.00% 0
		4

Showing rows 1 - 6 of 6

Q13 - How would you compare this instructor with others from whom you have taken graduate level courses?

#	Field	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Std Deviation	Variance	Count
1	How would you compare this instructor with others from whom you have taken graduate level courses?	1.00	1.00	1.00	0.00	0.00	4

#	Field	Choice Count
1	Upper 10%	100.00% 4
2	Upper 25%	0.00% 0
3	Middle 50%	0.00% 0
4	Lower 25%	0.00% 0
5	Lower 10%	0.00% 0
		4

Showing rows 1 - 6 of 6

Q14 - What teaching methods worked well in this Workshop? [e.g. screen-sharing; breakout rooms; asynchronous interactions; etc.]

What teaching methods worked well in this Workshop? [e.g. screen-sharing; b...

Bruce is cool. I find him very approachable and I thought his enthusiasm for the class was high. I had a great time!

The tutorials are extremely helpful. I might suggest a pre-class prep sheet that tells us the packages to download in preparation for the class.

Q16 - What were your greatest challenges in remote learning for this Workshop?[e.g. internet connectivity; learning via Zoom; personal motivation; managing life stresses; etc.]

What were your greatest challenges in remote learning for this Workshop?[e....

N/A

Q39 - Given the technical facilities used during class sessions, how would you evaluate:

#	Field	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Std Deviation	Variance	Count
1	Zoom	1.00	1.00	1.00	0.00	0.00	4
2	Ability of online participants to ask questions	1.00	1.00	1.00	0.00	0.00	4

#	Field	Worked well		Worked alright		Didn't work well		Didn't work at all		Total
1	Zoom	100.00%	4	0.00%	0	0.00%	0	0.00%	0	4
2	Ability of online participants to ask questions	100.00%	4	0.00%	0	0.00%	0	0.00%	0	4

Showing rows 1 - 2 of 2

Q40 - When considering the Summer Program for your methods training, do you recall whether this Workshop, or any other Summer Program Workshops, were similar to any courses of instruction offered at your home institution?

#	Field	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Std Deviation	Variance	Count
1	When considering the Summer Program for your methods training, do you recall whether this Workshop, or any other Summer Program Workshops, were similar to any courses of instruction offered at your home institution?	1.00	2.00	1.75	0.43	0.19	4

#	Field	Choice Count
1	Yes	25.00% 1
2	No	75.00% 3
3	I don't have a home institution	0.00% 0
		4

Showing rows 1 - 4 of 4

Q41 - Why did you choose to take this Workshop from the Summer Program instead of an alternative available your home institution?

Why did you choose to take this Workshop from the Summer Program instead of...

Q42 - Did you consider other methods-training programs similar to the ICPSR Summer Program?

#	Field	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Std Deviation	Variance	Count
1	Did you consider other methods-training programs similar to the ICPSR Summer Program?	2.00	2.00	2.00	0.00	0.00	4

#	Field	Choice Count
1	Yes	0.00% 0
2	No	100.00% 4

4

Showing rows 1 - 3 of 3

Q43 - Why did you choose the ICPSR Summer Program for this Workshop?

Why did you choose the ICPSR Summer Program for this Workshop?

Q27 - Do you have any additional comments you would like to share?

Do you have any additional comments you would like to share?

End of Report